

web and software solutions for corporates, has around 250 clients. Gopinath's India office—he won't disclose his turnover as he is about to divest a stake to a London-based company—alone brings in revenues of around \$2.5 million (Rs 9.8 crore). It kickstarted last year. Ask him to count his achievements and Gopinath lists his entry into the *Limca Book of Records* in 2006 as the world's youngest executive. "It made my family proud."

As Gopinath plots his next move, Aseem Badshah is sleepless in Seattle. He's just finished posting a link for Mashup 2007, a teen-technology conference where he was a speaker, on Facebook. Now it's time to catch up with buddies. "I like socialising

and partying," he says. In an hour, he leaves for Los Angeles, where he's exchanging notes with competitors and potential partners. All the while he's plugged into hip-hop on his Zune. His start-up Scriptovia (launched with pocket money savings and investment in shares) is still in the beta stage and he needs to find some funding before he launches it in January 2008. But more importantly, it is Badshah's second venture—he launched Think-essay.com in 2005. It allowed students to learn from each other's essays through social networking. He has also interned with Microsoft Corporation and at 11, became the youngest person to earn the Microsoft Office User Specialist certification. Now, at 19, he is juggling school (Washington Business School) and his start-up. Phew!

While Badshah has been mastering his juggling act, Chirag Bhatia, 20, and his friend Varun Parikh, also 20, have been matching notes. A student of business management at Mumbai's Jai Hind College,

Bhatia started Radicals, a temporary staffing company for students, with Parikh last year. They came across people who were staffing for event management companies from colleges and thought it would be a good idea to leverage their own networking skills. First month on the job, they placed six students. "We took up temporary jobs ourselves to understand what kind of work needed to be done," says a proud Bhatia. In six months, they had managed to place around 250 students (on a temporary basis, of course) and today boast of companies like Wizcraft Entertainment, Coca-Cola India and Sony-BMG as clients in their dossier. Radicals has a turnover of Rs 2 lakh per annum and Bhatia hopes to up it to Rs 10 lakh by the next fiscal.

Till recently, young entrepreneurs looked upon Google founders Larry Page and Sergey Brin as role models. Now, a growing number of young Indians who transact across a flat world are emerging as icons of their time.

When brothers Bhavin and Divyank Turakhia were 15 and 13, respectively, they made money by finishing their classmates' computer projects. They also started a job portal, did consultancy for companies like Orionsoft and set up intranets for many a corporates. In 1998, they borrowed Rs 25,000 from their parents to pay for server lease fees. Within a month, they had not only repaid the loan but

DIVYANK TURAKHIA, 25 & BHAVIN TURAKHIA, 27

Mumbai

COMPANY: Directi. A web products company that devises online ad solutions, web hosting, site building.

HOW THEY'LL SPEND THEIR FIRST MILLION: Already worth \$300 million

WHEN NOT AT WORK THEY ARE: Gaming. They own a Wii, Xbox 360 and a PS2.

"Those starting out must have a clear vision and be committed to it."



BHASKAR PAUL